

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Project Design Phase: Problem – Solution Fit Template

Date:	October 3, 2026	Maximum Marks:	4 Marks
Team ID:	SWTID-2026-2585	Project Name:	Standard Laptop Automation

Problem – Solution Fit Template:

The Problem-Solution Fit simply means that you have found a problem with your customer and that the solution you have realized for it actually solves the customer's problem. It helps entrepreneurs, marketers and corporate innovators identify behavioral patterns and recognize what would work and why.

Purpose:

- Automate standard laptop procurement using ServiceNow Flow Designer to slash delivery times by 70% and guarantee Day-1 onboarding readiness.
- Solve complex problems in a way that fits the state of your customers: Remove friction in ordering enterprise hardware by providing pre-configured options and transparent tracking.
- Succeed faster and increase your solution adoption by tapping into existing mediums and channels of behavior: Deliver order updates and approval prompts directly inside existing tools like Microsoft Teams, Slack, and email.
- Sharpen your communication and marketing strategy with the right triggers and messaging: Trigger automated requests directly from HR onboarding tools or lifecycle replacement milestones.
- Increase touch-points with your company by finding the right problem-behavior fit and building trust by solving frequent annoyances, or urgent or costly problems: Eliminate constant "Where is my laptop?" pings and long wait times for critical business hardware.
- Understand the existing situation in order to improve it for your target group: Replace disconnected spreadsheets and manual email approvals with an integrated, automated procurement flow.

TEMPLATE:

Problem-Solution fit canvas 2.0		PURPOSE& VISION: Automate standard laptop procurement using ServiceNow Flow Designer to slash delivery times by 70% and guarantee Day-1 onboarding readiness.	
Define CS, fit into	1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) Primary: Enterprise Employees and Hiring Managers requesting standard hardware. Secondary: IT Operations, Procurement Teams, and IT Service Desk Agents responsible for fulfilling asset requests.	6. CUSTOMER Fixed IT Budget and approval thresholds. Strict compliance, security and hardware configuration requirements across different employee roles. Vendor inventory lead times and existing procurement contract constraints.	5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS Manual Email & Spreadsheet Workflows Approvals managed via email, tracked manually on Excel sheets, and manually ordered from suppliers. Custom Legacy Scripts: Ad-hoc custom code/scripts running background automations, which are fragile, difficult to maintain, and lack clear visibility.
	2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE/ PROBLEMS Job-To-Be-Done: Request standard laptops for new hires or hardware refreshes quickly and track fulfillment status in real time. Problems: Manual approvals and routing cause severe delays in onboarding. Procurement and IT teams spend excessive time doing manual entry across ServiceNow, ERP's, and vendor portals. Lack of visibility into order progress leads to frequent "Where is my laptop?" support tickets.	9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE Disconnected systems (HR, IT Service Desk, Vendor inventory) operating in silos with no unified barcode automation layer to orchestrate approvals, ticket routing, and purchase orders automatically.	7. BEHAVIOUR Users frequently ping IT support agents directly on Slack/Teams for status updates due to lack of visibility. Managers delay approving requests or miss email notification approvals among high inbox volume.
Focus on J&P, lay into BE, understand	3. TRIGGERS Employee Onboarding: HR submits a new hire request triggering a hardware requirement. Hardware Refresh Cycle: An employee's device reaches end-of-life (3-4 years). Device Damage/Failure: Urgent hardware replacement request submitted via the IT Service Portal.	10. YOUR SOLUTION An automated end-to-end procurement workflow built using ServiceNow Flow Designer. Automated Catalog Item: Self-service request form with pre-approved hardware configurations. Dynamic Approval Routing: Automatically routes approvals to line managers based on cost and employee level. Automated Fulfillment Flow: Automatically generates vendor purchase orders or assigns warehouse provisioning tasks upon approval. Real-time Integration & Notifications: Sends real-time status updates to users via Microsoft Teams/Slack and updates ITAM inventory automatically.	8. CHANNELS of BEHAVIOUR 8.1 ONLINE: ServiceNow Service Portal, automated Microsoft Teams/Slack notifications, email approval links, IT Asset Management (ITAM) dashboards. 8.2 OFFLINE: IT helpdesk physical pickup centers, warehouse asset tagging/inventory handling.
Identify strong TR & EM	4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER Before: Frustrated by long wait times, confused by opaque approval workflows, anxious about new hires starting without equipment on Day 1. After: Confident, delighted by seamless 1-click ordering, relieved by automated multi-stage notifications, and satisfied with fast delivery turnaround.		Extract online & offline CH of BE

References:

1. <https://www.idealhackers.network/problem-solution-fit-canvas/>
2. <https://medium.com/@epicantus/problem-solution-fit-canvas-aa3dd59cb4fe>